

Fourth Suit Forcing New Minor Forcing Help Suit Game Try

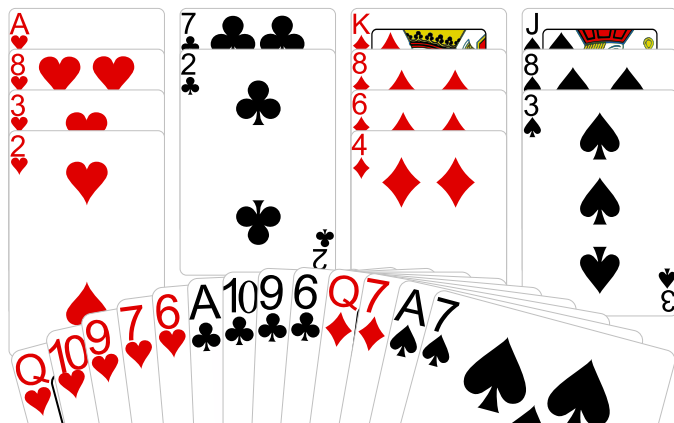
FSF : Suppose the partnership has already mentioned three suits, and the player who is next to bid wants to make a forcing bid but has no bid that is really descriptive of his hand. He just bids the fourth suit (whether he has it or not). This asks partner to further describe her hand.

NMF : Similar to FSF, this is Responder's second bid after she makes a suit response to partner's suit opening and Opener then bids Notrump. Bidding a previously unbid (New) minor suit asks for further description.

HSGT : When the bidding starts 1Major - 2Major, Opener can invite to game by bidding 3Major. A more descriptive invitation is to bid a different suit; this is also an invitation to game but asks partner to pay particular attention to whether he can "Help" in that suit.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these three conventions.

Deal 1 Ctr: 2♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



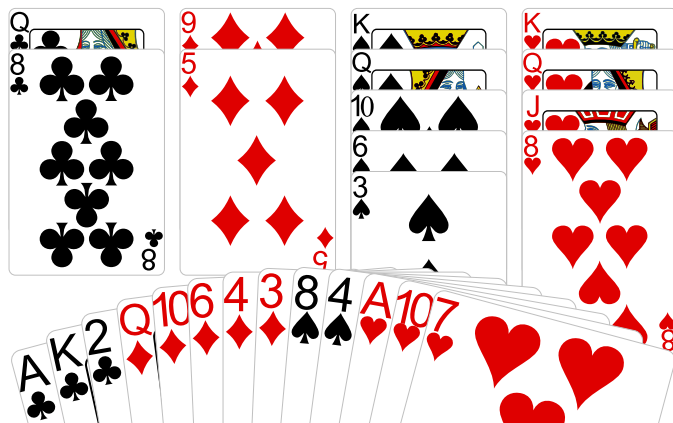
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 2 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Deal 3 Ctr: 4♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



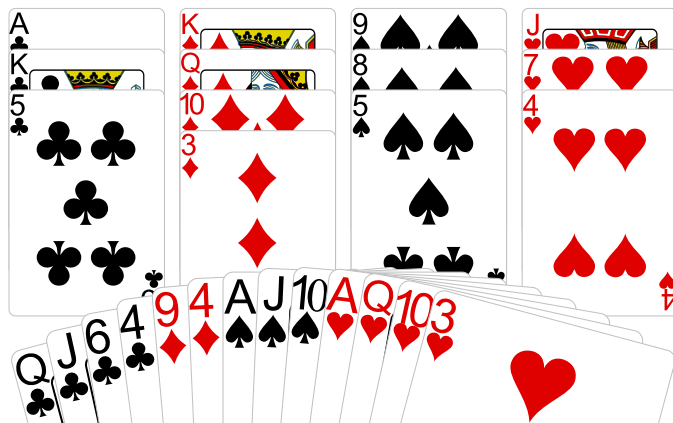
Count Fast and Slow Losers

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Reduce Losers

Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length

Deal 4 Ctr: 3NT Goal: at least ____ winners



Count Sure Winners

♠	♥	♦	♣	Total

Decide How to Develop Winners

Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 2♥

Declarer: North

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: West

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: North

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q T 9 2

♥ 5 4

♦ A 5 3

♣ K Q 8 5

♠ A 7

♥ Q T 9 7 6

♦ Q 7

♣ A T 9 6



♠ K 6 5 4

♥ K J

♦ J T 9 2

♣ J 4 3

♠ J 8 3

♥ A 8 3 2

♦ K 8 6 4

♣ 7 2

NORTH should pass 2♥. She is not strong enough to try for game.

West

North

East

South

1♥

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by North

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K Q T 6 3

♥ K Q J 8

♦ 9 5

♣ Q 8

♠ 9 7 5

♥ 4 3 2

♦ A J 7

♣ J 9 7 3



♠ 8 4

♥ A T 7

♦ Q T 6 4 3

♣ A K 2

♠ A J 2

♥ 9 6 5

♦ K 8 2

♣ T 6 5 4

WEST knows there should be game, but doesn't know whether it will be 4♠, 4♥ or 3NT. To find out which she uses NMF and bids 2♣ at her second turn.

EAST does not have a 4-card ♥ suit, nor does he have three ♠s, but he does have ♣s stopped so he bids 2NT, which West raises to 3NT.

West	North	East	South
		1♦	Pass
1♠	Pass	1NT	Pass
2♣	Pass	2NT	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by East			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q T 9 2

♥ A 7

♦ Q T 7 3

♣ 9 7 6

♠ K 5 3

♥ T 9 5 3

♦ 9 8 6 4

♣ K Q



♠ 8 7 6 4

♥ 6 2

♦ K J 2

♣ A T 8 3

♠ A J

♥ K Q J 8 4

♦ A 5

♣ J 5 4 2

SOUTH cannot see a game unless NORTH has help in ♣s so she makes a Help Suit Game Try.

NORTH has 8 points and the doubleton ♣ K Q so he bids the game.

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

Pass

1♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

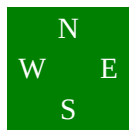
Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J T
 ♥ A Q T 3
 ♦ 9 4
 ♣ Q J 6 4

♠ K 6 3
 ♥ 9 8 2
 ♦ J 8 5 2
 ♣ 9 8 2



♠ 9 8 5
 ♥ J 7 4
 ♦ K Q T 3
 ♣ A K 5

♠ Q 7 4 2
 ♥ K 6 5
 ♦ A 7 6
 ♣ T 7 3

EAST has a perfect hand on which to use Fourth Suit Forcing. If West can stop ♠s, then 3NT would be a great contract.

There is one problem - if EAST bids 1♠ at her second turn it is NOT considered FSF, so she must jump to 2♠.

WEST, win a fine ♠ stopper, bids 3NT.

West	North	East	South
1♣	Pass	1♦	Pass
1♥	Pass	2♠	Pass
3NT			
All Pass			
3NT by West			

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 6
♥ 9 4 2
♦ Q 5 4 2
♣ 8 7 6 2

♠ Q 7 5

♥ J T 7 6

♦ A 8

♣ K Q J 3



♠ A J 9

♥ A 5

♦ K J T 9 6

♣ T 9 4

♠ K 8 4 3 2

♥ K Q 8 3

♦ 7 3

♣ A 5

SOUTH's 2♦ bid is a perfect example of NMF. It provides NORTH with the opportunity to show either a 4-card ♥ suit, OR 3-card ♠ support.

In this hand NORTH actually has both. When that happens, showing the ♥s is first priority.

West	North	East	South
	1♣	Pass	1♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♥	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by North			